



TEENS & KIDS MINISTRY MANUAL

POLICIES & STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES

1. GENERAL PRINCIPLES & VOLUNTEER ELIGIBILITY

Requirements to Serve

- **Age & Faith:** Volunteers must be of the age of accountability, a confessing Christian who understands sound doctrine, and willing to serve.
- **Church Membership:** Church membership is preferred but not strictly required. Non-members who have not undergone formal church discipline are eligible to serve, allowing them to explore their God-given talents.
- **Special Roles:** Nursery staffing may eventually include paid part-time employees as growth and funding allow. Non-members serving with children (outside nursery) will be screened for doctrinal alignment.
- **Background Check:** Must pass a church-issued background check prior to beginning service. Background checks must be renewed every 2 years.
- **Training Requirement:** All adult volunteers must read this manual and complete the child abuse prevention and reporting training in Central Check-In (More > Training) before serving. Their check-in access unlocks once it is complete.
- **Minor Volunteer Policy:** An exception to the background check rule exists for any minor who serves. Minor volunteers must be in good standing, exhibit good character, and always serve alongside an approved adult volunteer (minors cannot serve alone). Youth volunteers are also exempt from child abuse training; the legal and ministry responsibility always rests with the adult with whom that youth volunteer is serving.

How to Volunteer

1. **Express Interest:** Verbally notify any church staff member or leadership.
2. **Provide Contact Details:** Contact the church office with your full name, phone number, and email address.
3. **Screening & Onboarding:** Upon background check clearance and prayerful consideration by the Youth Pastor, the volunteer will be added to Central Check-In and onboarded by reading this manual and completing the child abuse training in the app.

2. MINISTRY SCHEDULES & ANNUAL EVENTS

Regular Weekly Services

Ministry Program	Schedule	Age / Grade Group
Sunday School	Sundays @ 9:30 AM	All Ages / Youth

Ministry Program	Schedule	Age / Grade Group
Children's Church	Sundays @ 10:45 AM	Children
Central Kids	Wednesdays @ 6:00 PM – 7:45 PM	Elementary (Grades K–5)
Central Teens	Wednesdays @ 6:00 PM – 7:45 PM	Youth (Grades 6–12)

* Volunteers are expected to arrive early whenever possible.

Annual Events & Volunteer Opportunities

Kids VBS: Summer

Teens VBS: Includes local/regional field trip

Kids Camp & Super Summer: 5 weekdays during summer

Teens Dessert Donation Auction: Youth Camp Fundraiser (*Begins winter 2026 / early 2027*)

Winter Jam: One evening in winter (*Begins 2027*)

Fellowship Nights: Skate Night / Pool Night / Movie Night (*Begins 2027*)

3. CORE SAFETY & PROTECTION PROTOCOLS

General Rules & Physical Safety

- **Group Supervision Rule:** At least one adult must be present with a group of children at all times to ensure the youth's safety. This is not to be followed legalistically. There will be times where one volunteer walks a kid to the restroom while the other stays in the larger group. This is when and why the group supervision rule is applicable.
- **Two-Adult Rule:** Private conversations with minors must always have two adults. Any time a room dwindles down to just a few people, this becomes strictly applicable.
- **Open Door / Window Policy:** Classroom doors must remain open or have an unobstructed window so activities remain visible from the hallway.
- **Restroom Procedures:** Volunteers must stand in the hallway during bathroom breaks.
- **Sick Child Policy:** Children must be fever-free for 24 hours without medication and free of contagious symptoms before attending. Any child that is symptomatic should stay home.
- **Medication Administration:** Volunteers are strictly prohibited from administering prescription or over-the-counter medications without written parental consent forms on file.
- **Transportation & Drivers:** Chaperones driving youth must meet minimum age requirements, possess a clean driving record, pass a motor vehicle background check, maintain valid insurance, and never drive alone with a single child.
- **Outdoor & Playground Safety:** Move indoors immediately if thunder is heard, lightning is seen, or rain begins.

Volunteer Ratios

Age / Ministry Group	Adult-to-Child Ratio	Minimum Required Staffing
Nursery & Infants (Ages 0–2)	1 : 4	Minimum 2 vetted adults/teens in the room
Preschool & Young Children (Ages 3–5)	1 : 6	Minimum 2 vetted adults/teens in the room
Elementary Children (Grades K–5)	1 : 8–10	Minimum 2 vetted adults in the room
Teens & Youth (Grades 6–12)	1 : 8–10	Minimum 2 vetted adults present for any activity

OVER-RATIO OVERRIDE

The Two-Adult Rule always overrides room ratios so there should always be two adults (e.g., even if only one infant is in the nursery, two vetted adults must still be present).

4. CENTRAL CHECK-IN SECURITY & DISMISSAL SYSTEM

Central Baptist Church utilizes its own custom check-in software, **Central Check-In**, as our electronic secure check-in and attendance management platform. All parents, guardians, and ministry volunteers must adhere to the following check-in and pickup procedures to guarantee the physical security of all minors.

1. Registration & Check-In

- **Parent Setup:** All families (Nursery through Elementary) must set up their family in Central Check-In online (using the church's sign-up link) or at the check-in station prior to or upon arrival.
- **Label Printing:** Upon check-in at the check-in station using the family name or parent's phone number, Central Check-In will print:
 - A **Child Name Tag** (showing the child's first name, assigned class, check-in date and time, and a red symbol for any recorded medical conditions or allergies).
 - A matching **Guardian Security Claim Tag** featuring a unique, randomized alphanumeric code and barcode.
- **Tag Placement:** The child's name tag must be firmly placed on the back of the child's clothing before entering any classroom or ministry area.

2. Special Medical & Allergy Alerts

Any critical medical conditions, severe food allergies, or special needs listed in the child's Central Check-In profile will automatically print directly on the child's name tag. Volunteers must double-check name tags during check-in and strictly enforce all posted dietary or medical restrictions.

3. Secure Classroom Dismissal

- **Matching Claim Tag Required:** Children will only be released to an adult presenting the physical Guardian Security Claim Tag matching the child's security code. Volunteers scan the claim tag's barcode, or enter its code, in Central Check-In to confirm the match.
- **Roster Verification:** Room leaders must visually match the code on the child's label with the parent's claim tag prior to opening classroom doors.
- **Authorized Pickups:** If a parent is unavailable, children will only be released to individuals explicitly listed as authorized pickup personnel in the child's Central Check-In profile.
- **Lost Claim Tag Protocol:** If a parent loses their claim tag, the volunteer must not release the child. Direct the parent to the Youth Pastor or designated Check-In Coordinator, who will manually verify identity against the parent's photo ID and Central Check-In profile before authorizing release.

5. BEHAVIORAL MANAGEMENT & EMERGENCY PROCEDURES

Behavioral Management & Discipline

- **Step 1 — Warning:** Provide a clear verbal correction.
- **Step 2 — Time-Out:** Place the child in a designated time-out chair in the room.
- **Step 3 — Parent Intervention:** If the child does not comply, send a leader to retrieve the parent/guardian to meet in the lobby. The child will join their parent in the main service for the remainder of the day. They may return the following week.
- **Soiled Clothing:** Assist the child to the restroom, then immediately retrieve the parent if backup clothing is unavailable.

Life-Threatening or Severe Safety Violations

Definition: Any action or speech physically threatening the well-being of another (e.g., weapon brandishing, physical fighting, sexual assault/harassment).

Response Protocol:

1. Immediately protect the safety and physical well-being of all children present.
2. Once the room is secure, immediately contact the Youth Pastor and/or Deacons, who will contact parents.
3. Physical restraint is a last resort—use common sense, self-control, and immediate peer intervention to protect others from a reckless child.

Medical Emergencies & Mandatory Reporting

- **Life-Threatening Emergency:** Call 911 immediately. Send a volunteer to notify the parent/guardian and a pastor or deacon.
- **Minor Injuries:** Render immediate care using proper protective gloves/masks. Once stable, notify the Youth Pastor or Deacon, who will contact parents and determine if paramedics are necessary.
- **Incident Reports:** Complete an incident report in Central Check-In (More > Incident reports) for all injuries, major misbehavior, or emergency events within 24 hours. The Youth Pastor and church admins are notified automatically.
- **Mandatory Child Abuse Reporting:** As an official policy of Central Baptist Church, any suspected child abuse or neglect involving a minor (17 and under) must be reported immediately to law enforcement or child protective services.

Direct Duty: If a child reports sexual abuse or physical abuse in confidence to you, you must personally file the report. Do not delegate this duty to a superior. Call the Winfield Police Department or the Kansas Protection Report Center (1-800-922-5330, 24/7) directly to fulfill this obligation.

- **Storage of Reporting:** Incident reports are stored securely in Central Check-In, visible only to the Youth Pastor and church admins, and kept for liability and insurance compliance.

6. OFF-SITE ACTIVITIES & SPECIAL EVENTS

- **Permission & Consent Slips:** Central Baptist permission forms must be signed and turned in prior to any off-site camp or trip.
- **3rd-Party Waivers:** Parents must complete all necessary waivers required by 3rd-party venues visited during youth trips.
- **Special Services:** Teen Worship and Testimony Services (Wednesday nights) or Sunday Youth Services require approved adult oversight following standard safety guidelines.

7. MUSIC, WORSHIP & EDUCATION

- **Music Guidelines:** Great freedom will be given in regard to the music played during free time or game time at church. Artists like KB, Lecrae, TobyMac, Skillet, and similar artists can be played so long as the lyrics honor God and contain no profanity. Even secular songs may occasionally be played during game time, provided there is strictly no profanity.
- **Worship Standards:** Students will worship using modern worship songs that exalt Jesus, as well as worship songs that honor and revere God.
- **Educational Standards:** We will preach the Word in season and out. No matter what curriculum, materials, or activities you use, ensure that everything lines up with the Bible. God's Word is our ultimate plumb line.